Cider orchard Recommendations

32-Tree Planting Plan — Old Traditional Varieties - $1,651.90 ($2200-2400 with shipping)

Bittersweet (High Tannin, Low Acid) – 14 Trees

Dabinett – 6 trees

- watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8mNPTJTRZNg
- Fire blight susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Cold hardiness: **~ -20°F to -25°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **October 10 – October 25**
- Cider profile: **High tannin, low acid (bittersweet)**
- Notes: Core tannin backbone apple.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Moderate to high
- **Biennial Management:** Thin aggressively in heavy years, especially within 2–3 weeks after bloom. Reduce clusters to one fruit per spur. Maintain good light penetration with pruning. Avoid excessive nitrogen.
- https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/dabinette
- Root Stock: B.118 - Maturity 18-21'
- 5'-6' or 3/4" Caliper
- $51
- — — —
- https://fedcoseeds.com/trees/dabinett-cider-apple-7286
- $36
- m111

Somerset Redstreak – 3 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Moderate to high susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Cold hardiness: **~ -20°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **October 1 – October 15**
- Cider profile: **High tannin, low acid (bittersweet)**
- Notes: Excellent tannin quality, slightly softer wood.
- **Biennial Tendency:** High

- **Biennial Management:** Requires strict early thinning every heavy year. Remove excess fruit decisively. Keep tree healthy and disease pressure low, as stress worsens alternation.
- $40
- https://www.orangepippintrees.com/trees/cider-apple-trees/somerset-redstreak
- Mature height: 10ft-16ft after 10 years
- B.118 rootstock

Major – 3 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Low to moderate susceptibility**
- Cold hardiness: **~ -25°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **September 20 – October 5**
- Cider profile: **High tannin, low acid (bittersweet)**
- Notes: Productive and relatively dependable.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Moderate
- **Biennial Management:** Moderate thinning. Remove crowded clusters and maintain balanced vigor. Generally more dependable than other English types.
- 12-14 at maturity - dwarf
- root stock:G.41
- $60
- https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/major-apple
- 6-7' or 3/4" caliper

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https://fedcoseeds.com/trees/major-cider-apple-7293
Rootstock m111

• Chisel Jersey – 2 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Cold hardiness: **~ -20°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **September 20 – October 5**
- Cider profile: **High tannin, low acid (bittersweet)**
- Notes: Strong tannin contributor.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Moderate to high
- **Biennial Management:** Thin early and hard during heavy sets. Do not allow overcropping. Maintain open canopy structure for good light.

- https://www.cumminsnursery.com/buy-trees/product-detail.php?type=tree&id=14915
- Root stock: G.890
- half standard
- $40
- — —
- https://www.treesofantiquity.com/products/chisel-jersey-apple-1
- **$54.95**
- **Root Stock MM111 - 75-85% -** 15–25 ft tall
-

Bittersharp (High Tannin, High Acid) - 7 Trees

• Kingston Black – 4 trees

- watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7pDKa0xS6MQ
- Fire blight susceptibility: **High susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Cold hardiness: **~ -20°F to -25°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **October 5 – October 20**
- Cider profile: **High tannin, high acid (bittersharp)**
- Notes: True classic, but your highest disease-risk tree in this mix.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Moderate
- **Biennial Management:** Moderate thinning. More sensitive to disease stress than overcropping alone, so prioritize overall tree health.
- https://www.treesofantiquity.com/products/kingston-black-apple
- $57
- MM111
- **Mature Size:** 12-16 ft.
- — — —
- https://www.orangepippintrees.com/trees/cider-apple-trees/kingston-black
- standard p.18 or semi standard MM111
- $40
- — — —
- https://raintreenursery.com/products/kingston-black-cider-apple-semi-dwarf
- $65
- mature height 13-15’
- Semi-Dwarf Rootstock: MM106

• Brown Snout– 3 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Cold hardiness: **~ -25°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **September 25 – October 10**
- Cider profile: **High tannin, medium to high acid (bittersharp)**
- Notes: More stable than Kingston Black.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Moderate
- **Biennial Management:** Light to moderate thinning. Fairly stable if not overloaded.
- https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/browns-snout?variant=45421334102212
- 18-21'
- B118
- 6'7 Feet tall bare root
- $51
- — —
- https://www.treesofantiquity.com/products/brown-snout-apple-tree
- root stock MM 111
- **Mature Size:** 12-16 ft.
- **$56.95**

Sharp (Low Tannin, High Acid) - 9 Trees

• Liberty – 6 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Low susceptibility (resistant)**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Very low susceptibility (resistant)**
- Cold hardiness: **~ -30°F to -35°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **September 10 – September 25**
- Cider profile: **Low tannin, high acid (sharp)**
- Notes: Your orchard insurance tree.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Low
- **Biennial Management:** Light thinning only when heavily set. Naturally consistent annual producer.
- https://www.orangepippintrees.com/trees/apple-trees/liberty
- small 1 year old bare root
- $40
- standard and semi standard
- https://raintreenursery.com/products/liberty-apple-dwarf?variant=31817582313527
- 4-5'
- standard available

- Standard Rootstock: Antonovka
- $60

• Antonovka – 2 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Low susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Low to moderate susceptibility**
- Cold hardiness: **~ -40°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **September 1 – September 15**
- Cider profile: **Low tannin, very high acid (sharp)**
- Notes: Extremely hardy, very vigorous.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Low to moderate
- **Biennial Management:** Usually self-balancing. Thin in very heavy years. Strong vigor helps maintain annual cropping.
- https://www.treesofantiquity.com/products/antonovka-apple-tree
- $57
- **Mature Size:** 12-16 ft.
- Rootstock mm111

• Brown's Apple – 1 tree

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Cold hardiness: **~ -20°F to -25°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **September 15 – September 30**
- Cider profile: **Medium tannin, high acid (sharp leaning toward bittersharp)**
- Notes: Excellent acid blender.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Moderate
- **Biennial Management:** Moderate thinning during heavy crop years. Maintain canopy light exposure.
- https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/browns-apple-tree
- $51
- 18-21' mature
- 6-7' shipping size

Sweet / Aromatic (Sugar & Fermentation Character) - 2 Trees

• Golden Russet – 2 trees

watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=i_15OwJ2vel

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**

- Cold hardiness: **~ -25°F to -30°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **October 10 – October 25**
- Cider profile: **Low to medium tannin, medium acid (sweet/aromatic)**
- Notes: High sugar, great fermentation aromatics.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Moderate to high
- **Biennial Management:** Thin hard in heavy years. Known to overcrop and rest if unmanaged. Critical to reduce fruit load early.
- https://www.starkbros.com/products/fruit-trees/apple-trees/golden-russet-apple
- 12-15' tall
- ships 3-4' tall
- $40
- https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/golden-russet?variant=38015222415556
- $51
- 15-17'
- ships 6-7'
- mm.106

Final Tree Count

Category	Trees
Bittersweet	14
Bittersharp	7
Sharp	9
Sweet/Aromatic	2
Total	**32**

🔎 Updated Risk Snapshot

Highest Fire Blight Risk

- Kingston Black
- Somerset Redstreak

Moderate Risk

- Dabinett
- Major
- Chisel Jersey
- Cap of Liberty
- Brown's Apple
- Golden Russet

Low Risk / Strong Resistance

- Liberty
- Antonovka

Modern-Focused Cider Orchard Recommendation — 32 Trees - $1,783 ($2300-$2600 with shipping)

🌳 Bittersweet (Body & Tannin) – 10 Trees

Modern bittersweets are rare, so we lean on newer Midwest / American selections that behave like bittersweets but are more resilient.

Driftless Cider Varieties – 6 trees

- Brown Snout, Yarlington Mill, Rubinette
- **Brown Snout**
  Biennial Tendency: Moderate
  Biennial Management: Light to moderate thinning. Fairly stable if not overloaded, thin early in heavy years to prevent a big on-year that triggers an off-year.
- **Yarlington Mill**
  Biennial Tendency: Moderate to high
  Biennial Management: Thin early and decisively in heavy years, especially within 2–3 weeks after bloom. Reduce clusters to one fruit per spur and keep the canopy open for light, this variety will alternate if allowed to carry a full load.
- **Rubinette**
  Biennial Tendency: High
  Biennial Management: Requires aggressive thinning in heavy years. Rubinette is prone to overcropping and then resting, so thin early, keep fruit well spaced, and avoid letting the tree carry a “show-off” crop if you want annual production.
- watch Yarlington Mill: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lp81PXYgGh0
- watch Rubinette: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UjHwgQxbTb8
- Fire blight susceptibility: **Low to moderate susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Low to moderate susceptibility**
- Cold hardiness: **Tolerant to approximately -25°F to -30°F**

- Ripening window (Southern WI): **September 25 – October 10**
- Cider profile: **Medium-high tannin, balanced acid (modern bittersweet)**
- **brown snout: https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/browns-snout?variant=45421334102212**
- **$51**
- **18-21' tall**
- **Yarlington https://easthilltreefarm.com/products/yarlington-mill**
- **$90**
- **75-85%**
- Rubinette - **https://www.treesofantiquity.com/products/rubinette-apple?_pos=1&_psq=rubinette&_ss=e&_v=1.0**
- $57
- 4-5' shipping height
- MM111

• CrimsonCrisp – 2 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Low susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Very low susceptibility (resistant)**
- Cold hardiness: **Tolerant to approximately -25°F to -30°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **September 10 – September 25**
- Cider profile: **Medium tannin, medium acid (firm structure contributor)**
- **Biennial Tendency:** Low
- **Biennial Management:** Minimal thinning. Naturally consistent.
- https://www.starkbros.com/products/fruit-trees/apple-trees/crimsoncrisp-apple
- 12-15' tall
- $50
- https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/crimsoncrisp?variant=41771952177348
- MM106
- 16-18' tall
- $51
- 6-7' shipping or pickup

• GoldRush – 2 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Low to moderate susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Very low susceptibility (resistant)**
- Cold hardiness: **Tolerant to approximately -30°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **October 15 – October 30**

- Cider profile: **Medium tannin, high sugar, bright acid backbone**

GoldRush isn't technically a bittersweet, but in a modern orchard it plays a tannin + sugar role without the English disease baggage.

Biennial Tendency: Moderate

Biennial Management: Thin moderately. Heavy cropper that can alternate if allowed to overload.

- http://starkbros.com/products/fruit-trees/apple-trees/goldrush-apple
- $50
- 12-15' tall
- https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/goldrush?variant=43694275264708
- $51
- 17-21' tall
- 6-7' tall at shipping

🌳 Bittersharp (Acid + Structured Tannin) – 10 Trees

•Harry Masters Jersey – 5 trees

- **Fire blight susceptibility:** Moderate susceptibility
- **Apple scab susceptibility:** Moderate susceptibility
- **Cold hardiness: ~ -25°F**
- **Ripening window (Southern WI): Late September – Mid October**
- **Cider profile: Medium tannin, high acid**
- **Notes:** An heirloom bittersharp that produces complex, balanced cider. Can sub in for a Cornell selection where nursery availability is limited.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Moderate
- **Biennial Management:** Moderate thinning. Manage similarly to other English cider types.
- https://www.treesofantiquity.com/products/harry-master-jersey-apple
- $55
- MM111
- 12-16' tall
- 4-5' shipping
-

• FOXWHELP – 3 trees

- **Fire blight susceptibility:** Moderate to high susceptibility
- **Apple scab susceptibility:** Moderate susceptibility

- **Cold hardiness: ~ -25°F**
- **Ripening window (Southern WI): Late September – Early October**
- **Cider profile: High tannin, high acid**
- **Notes:** A powerhouse bittersharp that brings bold structure to blends.

Use as substitute: Adds both phenolic complexity and acid; great if you like punchier blends.
Biennial Tendency: Moderate to high
Biennial Management: Aggressive thinning in heavy years. Do not allow cluster crowding.

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- **https://raintreenursery.com/products/foxwhelp-cider-apple-semi-dwarf**
- **$65**
- Mature Height: 15'-18'
- Semi-Dwarf Rootstock: MM106

• WineCrisp – 2 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Low susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Very low susceptibility (resistant)**
- Cold hardiness: **Tolerant to approximately -25°F to -30°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **October 5 – October 20**
- Cider profile: **Medium tannin, firm acid, deep color contribution**
- **Biennial Tendency:** Low
- **Biennial Management:** Light thinning if needed. Generally stable.
- **https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/winecrisp?variant=42025650258116**
- **$51**
- Mature Height: B.118: ~18-21' tall; Semi-Dwarf
- 6-7’ tall

🌳 Sharp (Acid Backbone / Orchard Insurance) – 9 Trees

• Liberty – 5 trees

- watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0T5imywzUSk
- Fire blight susceptibility: **Low susceptibility (resistant)**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Very low susceptibility (resistant)**
- Cold hardiness: **~ -30°F to -35°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **September 10 – September 25**
- Cider profile: **Low tannin, high acid (sharp)**

- Notes: Your orchard insurance tree.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Low
- **Biennial Management:** Light thinning only when heavily set. Naturally consistent annual producer, focus more on canopy light and general health than aggressive crop control.
- https://www.orangepippintrees.com/trees/apple-trees/liberty
- small 1 year old bare root
- $40
- standard and semi standard
- https://raintreenursery.com/products/liberty-apple-dwarf?variant=31817582313527
- 4-5'
- standard available
- Standard Rootstock: Antonovka
- $60

Priscilla – 2 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Very low susceptibility (resistant)**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Low susceptibility**
- Cold hardiness: **Tolerant to approximately -30°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **September 15 – September 30**
- Cider profile: **Low tannin, medium acid**
- **Biennial Tendency:** Low
- **Biennial Management:** Minimal intervention. Strong annual bearer.
- **https://bluehillwildlifenursery.com/product/priscilla-apple-tree/**
- **$38**
- **20'+ tall**
- **4-6' tall at shipping**
-

Enterprise – 2 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Low susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Very low susceptibility (resistant)**
- Cold hardiness: **Tolerant to approximately -30°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **October 10 – October 25**
- Cider profile: **Low tannin, high acid, strong storage sugar accumulation**
- **Biennial Tendency:** Low to moderate
- **Biennial Management:** Light to moderate thinning during heavy sets.

- **https://www.starkbros.com/products/fruit-trees/apple-trees/enterprise-apple**
- **12-15' tall**
- **3-4' at shipping**
- **$40**
- **https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/enterprise?variant=40992641056964**
- **$41**
- **M111**
- **4-6' tall**

GoldRush Apple – Orchard Ready

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/goldrush

- **Price:** $51 — Hand-Select Bare Root (ships ~6–7′ tall)
- **Shipping Size:** ~6–7′ bare-root
- **Rootstock:** (Varies by nursery) often grafted onto semi-dwarf or dwarf apple rootstocks such as *M7, M111*, etc., affecting mature size
- **Mature Height:** ~10–21′ depending on rootstock (dwarf ~8–12′, semi-dwarf ~15–20′)
- **USDA Hardiness: Zone 4–9** — cold hardy when given a long enough season
- **Harvest Window: Late October – Early November (very late season)**
- **Bloom Group: Late Bloom (Group 5)** — blooms late relative to most apples
- **Pollination:** Requires cross-pollination with another apple cultivar
- **Disease Resistance:**
- **Scab:** *Field immune* (excellent resistance)
- **Powdery mildew:** *Highly resistant*
- **Fire blight:** *Moderately resistant*
- **Cedar-apple rust:** *Some susceptibility*
- **Fruit Characteristics:**
- Medium to large fruit, greenish-yellow skin often with blush
- Flesh very firm, crisp, bright juice with spicy sweet-tart profile
- **Taste & Usage:**
- **Fresh eating:** Best after storage (flavor mellows & sweetens)
- **Baking:** Excellent, holds texture
- **Cider:** High sugar & acid make it a favorite for blends
- **Storage:** Exceptional — 5–7+ months refrigerated or longer depending on conditions
- **Orchard Notes:**

- Heavy cropping, often precocious but may need *thinning* to avoid biennial bearing
- Late ripening demands a long season — plant in sheltered, sunny locations
- Late bloom timing helps avoid some spring frost risk relative to early bloomers

Summary: GoldRush is a **late-season dessert & storage apple** with **very strong disease resistance** and excellent flavor after storage. It produces high-quality fruit that keep for months and works well for eating, baking, cider, or storage. It needs *cross-pollination and a long growing season* to ripen fully in cold climates like Wisconsin but can be a terrific end-of-season addition to a balanced orchard.

🌳 Sweet / Aromatic (Sugar & Fermentation Character) – 3 Trees

• Golden Russet – 2 trees

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Cold hardiness: **~ -25°F to -30°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **October 10 – October 25**
- Cider profile: **Low to medium tannin, medium acid (sweet/aromatic)**
- Notes: High sugar, great fermentation aromatics.
- **Biennial Tendency:** Moderate
- **Biennial Management:** Moderate thinning. Avoid overcropping.
- https://www.starkbros.com/products/fruit-trees/apple-trees/golden-russet-apple
- 12-15’ tall
- ships 3-4’ tall
- $40
- https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/golden-russet?variant=38015222415556
- $51
- 15-17’
- ships 6-7’
- mm.106

• Roxbury Russet – 1 tree

- Fire blight susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**
- Apple scab susceptibility: **Moderate susceptibility**

- Cold hardiness: **Tolerant to approximately -25°F to -30°F**
- Ripening window (Southern WI): **October 5 – October 20**
- Cider profile: **Low tannin, rich sugar, fermentation depth**
- **Biennial Tendency:** Moderate
- **Biennial Management:** Moderate thinning. Avoid overcropping. If the set is heavy, thin early and aim for one fruit per cluster, with good spacing to preserve next year's flower buds.
- https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/roxbury-russet?variant=38041230147780
- **11-13' tall**
- **ships 6-7'**
- **$51**
- https://fedcoseeds.com/trees/roxbury-russet-apple-7257
- **m111**
- **$36**
- **2.5-5' tall**
- **65–80% of standard**

Final Tree Count

Category	Trees
Bittersweet	10
Bittersharp	10
Sharp	9
Sweet/Aromatic	3
Total	**32**

- No heavy English heritage exposure.
- Strong PRI/Cornell genetics for scab resistance.
- Fire blight risk mostly low across the orchard.
- Acid safety net is strong.
- Tannin depth is present but not fragile.
- Harvest window spreads from Sept 10 → Oct 30.

Why This Mix Works for Wisconsin

Disease Resistance

- Most selections are bred with **fire blight resistance**, especially Liberty, Priscilla, and the NY cider selections.
- Avoids heavy reliance on traditional English bittersweets that struggle in humid midwest conditions.

Acid Backbone

- Sharp trees are your guardrails for bright, balanced cider every year.

Tannin & Complexity

- Modern bittersweet and bittersharp choices give structure without as much disease risk.

Ripening Flow

- You have a spread from early September through late October that protects you from frost and harvest bottlenecks.